

Example Medical Group — Orthopedic Consultation

FICTIONAL DEMO DATA — not a real patient, firm, or provider.

Patient: Maria Delgado (fictional)

DOB: 04/11/1985 (fictional)

Date of visit: 2024-03-18 (fictional)

Treating physician: Dr. Sarah Chen, MD — Orthopedic Surgery

Referring event: motor vehicle collision, 2024-02-02 (fictional)

History of Present Illness

Ms. Delgado presents four weeks status-post a motor vehicle collision on 2024-02-02 (fictional). She reports she was a restrained driver, stopped at a red light, when her vehicle was struck from behind. She reports immediate onset of lower back pain radiating into the left leg, with associated numbness and tingling. She was evaluated at an emergency department the same day and was subsequently referred to this office for orthopedic evaluation.

Prior to the collision, the patient reports no history of lower back pain, no prior lumbar injury, and no prior spine treatment of any kind. She was fully active without limitation.

Assessment and Causation Opinion

MRI of the lumbar spine obtained on 2024-03-04 (fictional) demonstrates an L4-L5 disc herniation with associated left-sided nerve root impingement, correlating with the patient's reported radicular symptoms.

Causation:

It is my opinion, to a reasonable degree of medical certainty, that Ms. Delgado's L4-L5 disc herniation and associated radicular symptoms are causally related to the motor vehicle collision of 2024-02-02 (fictional). This opinion is based on the temporal relationship between the collision and symptom onset, the absence of any prior lumbar spine complaints in this patient's history, and imaging findings consistent with an acute traumatic disc injury rather than a chronic degenerative process.

Treatment Plan

Recommend a course of physical therapy, twice weekly for six weeks, with re-evaluation thereafter. Surgical intervention is not indicated at this time but may be reconsidered if conservative treatment fails to improve symptoms.

Sarah Chen, MD (fictional signature)